

CHECKING ON CHAPTER 7:*What it means to have a healthy ego*

Your ego is the mind-power which helps you project yourself and your desires. It can make you strong and resourceful, or put obstacles in your way, according to the sort of influence you feed it. We are familiar with the ego-boosting power of being well dressed, but a strong ego can rise above any limitation. When a man can afford to assert his ego in the ways he prefers, these ways often reflect long-ago influences.

A salesman sells through his ego

A good salesman knows that he is good and his product is good, and this confidence rarely falters. Sometimes a salesman's success hinges upon some ego-sustaining factor, or some outside circumstance may so affect his ego that he slides from a Yes attitude into a No attitude. A salesman may even assume his hearing is poor in order that he may filter the Nos out of his dialogue with a prospect. With a salesman or with anyone else, a real physical handicap can be a lifelong drawback or lifelong stimulus—depending upon the power of the ego.

Your ego and your opulence

When the ego is strong it attracts success. When the ego falters, it can be restored by making sure that every appearance and self-image is in its favor. A man who is used to living well, but has lowered his standard of living, can restore his prosperity by first restoring the feeling of prosperity that comes with appropriate possessions and actions. Even when an appearance of prosperity is assumed for a short time, it can prove the turning-point because that is what the ego needed. The ego may thus be guided by mysterious, all-pervasive powers.

Look for your ego-booster and you will find it

Ego is a highly individual matter. Observe the ways in which others boost their egos and you may be helped to find your own ways. Sometimes it is in the means of expressing ourselves that we best sustain our own egos, as in writing instead of speaking, or vice versa. When you find your own best way to boost your ego, you have found a great treasure.